

1960–1969

INTO THE SPACE AGE

The 1960s was the decade of space exploration, sparking vivid imaginings about what the future might be like. Fashion was quick to take up the themes – Pierre Cardin's *Space-Age* collection in 1964 began the trend – which continued into the 1970s – with Paco Rabanne, André Courrèges, and Rudi Gernreich soon following suit. The look included metallic or shiny cloth along with synthetic fabrics such as clear and coloured plastics, PVC, vinyl, and acrylic. Simple geometric shapes, A-line silhouettes, miniskirts, unisex styles, and bright colours created futuristic ensembles that appealed to the growing youth market.

Wide, stand-up collar of silvered PVC

White gabardine cotton

Circular motifs were common

Above the knee hemline

Metallic plastics Englishman John Bates, an early proponent of the miniskirt, designed this wedding ensemble for fashion journalist Marit Allen in 1966. Bates created the double-breasted coat with wide lapels, using shiny metallic polyester and PVC.

Futuristic Perspex visor recalls astronaut helmets

High-necked collar

Bare legs were a necessity with chainmail dresses

Blue plastic miniskirt

Modern geometry Designed in 1967 by Italian-born French designer Pierre Cardin, this black and blue plastic ensemble paired with a visor is modelled by American actress Raquel Welch. An instigator of space-age fashion, Cardin often focused on circular, and other geometric cut-outs, and straps.

Tights in various colours were popular, as well as black

Built-in booties

Matching chainmail headress

Short-sleeved dresses appealed to young generation

Geometric shapes linked with chain

The new armour Spanish-born French designer Paco Rabanne applied his love of jewellery design to dressmaking. He became well known for chainmail dresses, which linked plastic or metal geometric pieces together. Model Karin Jensen wears this example from 1968.